

OE3C Planning Meeting 11 Contents

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OE3C Planning Meeting 11

Meeting Details and Recording Link

Date: 19 Mar 2026

Location: CRN527/Online

Time: 11:01 AM – 12:06 PM

Attendees: Lyllian Corbin, Alex Wilder, Kiyoko Gotanda, Reem Mahamoud, Sarah Hein, Matthew Summerville, Cassia Hamilton, Wylan Clitheroe, Katherine Yagi, Abby DiMaria, Nicholas Benton, Harry Kumbhani

Chair: Alex Wilder

Minutes by: Lyllian Corbin

[Recap: OE3C Standing Meeting time March 19 | Meeting | Microsoft Teams](#)

Important Notes from Meeting

Post-meeting items for review (highlighted in minutes section):

Bold-faced text are hyperlinks to sections in this document (click to follow links).

- **Fundraising Updates**
 - o Draft of local sponsors request
- **Catering Update**
 - o Breakfast, lunch, and refreshments to accommodate up to 200 guests
- **Banquet Update**
 - o Configuration for the banquet in Market Hall
- **Workshops and Outings Update**
 - o Quote for school bus (Sharp) to Niagara Falls
- **Miscellaneous Update with Alex**
 - o Exhibit table for falconer (Abby's sister)
- **Merch Update**
 - o Note: merch order needs to be submitted by April 15th
 - o Need to decide on lanyards

Notes for all LOC members (red, bold-faced text in minutes section):

- Help reach out to local sponsors ASAP
- Help collect university info and send registration reminders ASAP
- LOC members will need to pay \$90 for their banquet tickets
- Registration dates:
 - o Deadline is March 29th, 2026 (will be extended to April 5th, 2026, later)
- Help send the volunteer call out to recruit volunteers
 - o LOC members can also sign up to be session chairs
- Need event monitors for the banquet – contact Alex
- Send Rasa any updates for the OE3C.ca website
- LOC meetings will be held weekly on Thursdays (11AM – 12PM)

Files from meeting (can be found under “Files & Documents” in Teams)

“Catering and Banquet” files

- Coffee break cost estimates Mar 2026.xlsx
 - o Spreadsheet contains estimated costs for all sections, across all days, **excluding the banquet**
- Potential banquet layout
 - o Folder contains 2 images of the rough banquet layout
- Market-Hall-Diagram.pdf
 - o Schematic of Market Hall's layout during term

Meeting Minutes

Call to Order

Alex began the meeting at 11:01 AM.

Fundraising Updates

- To save time, Alex will put updates in a post meeting form for review
 - o Fisher is willing to give us a sponsorship
 - o Medicom might give us something, but they told Alex they will see what they can do
- Draft of local fundraising pitch will be posted in the post meeting form
 - o **Alex needs help with reaching out to local sponsors**
 - She will also reach out to Amarak

Registration Update

- From Alex: We do not have enough funds for LOC members to attend the banquet for free
 - o Currently, we can only cover the costs of registration, so **LOC members will need to pay for the \$90 banquet ticket to attend**
- From Reem: Two people registered for the CCOVI event
 - o 6 more people outside of Brock registered
 - o 1 keynote used their discount code
 - o 12 people total are registered
- **LOC members are advised to help send out registration reminders**
 - o Lauren will try sending announcements from her student email and will CC the OE3C gmail
- **Registration soft deadline is March 29th, 2026**
 - o **The hard deadline is April 5th, 2026**
- From Nick: we received 2 abstract submissions so far (one is from an LOC member the other submission is from outside the LOC)

Catering Update

- From Lylly: we added more coffee breaks and food to the potential catering order spreadsheet
 - o Spreadsheet can be found here: [Coffee break cost estimates Mar 2026.xlsx](#)
 - o New order now includes sections for breakfast, morning break, lunch, afternoon break

- Sections vary by day (i.e. Thurs, Apr 30th does not include morning break)
 - Lunch order is to be determined
- From Alex: previous order assumed 1 serving per person (e.g., fruit trays, muffins, etc.), but they realised this will not be enough food for the 200 guests we are estimating for
 - Updated the order to accommodate up to 200 guests
 - We cannot bring in food outside of Brock's Dining due to their strict policies
 - Alex is reaching out to Amarak for a possible discount on food
 - Local sponsor idea: Alex is putting together a wishlist to help cover the costs of food
 - Pitch to local sponsors as, "their money is buying __," rather than pitching that they are giving us money
 - **Very important that everyone helps contact sponsors ASAP**

Banquet Update

- From Cassia: found a photo booth to have at the banquet
 - Premier booth
 - Cost is \$550 for 2 hrs
 - Includes digital photos, photo prints, and a standard backdrop
 - Reaching out to company for a discount
 - Configuration for the banquet
 - Front of the room will be closer to the stairs with check in nearby
 - Center of room will be the banquet area
 - food along walls
 - Cassia will upload the rough sketch of this configuration on teams
 - Can be found here: [Potential banquet layout](#)
 - Template of Market configuration during term is on Teams under Files & Docs
 - Diagram can be found here: [Market-Hall-Diagram.pdf](#)

Workshops and Outings Update

- From Sarah: buses for Niagara Falls outing
 - Quote from Sharp school bus line = \$487 (for 7:00-10:30 pm time slot)
- From Nick and Wylan: met with Jayne and Alison to discuss workshops

- Will be leading with Kiyoko's photo workshop first
- Knowledge mobilisation second
- Scientific podcasting third
- From Nick:
 - Computer science workshop with Rasa and Sowmya
 - Workshop will be on genetic algorithms for different problems and scenarios (involving the 3 E's)
 - How these algorithms are used
 - Filling in certain values to change the algorithm for each scenario
 - Will involve a game in which people can change the values and try to get the best values out of the simulation
 - Art display
 - Contacted Willow Arts Community
 - Discussing plans to include local art in common areas of conference
 - Alex mentioned that Paige's sister does vegan art
 - Wylan also has art to display
 - Alex confirmed that an app is being made for the scavenger hunt so people can scan the QR codes
 - QR codes will also be used for judging
- From Wylan:
 - Update on hikes
 - Getting studies done on the rewilding hike and mindfulness hike
 - Rewilding hike in the Quarry
 - The ecosystem before with Indigenous history
 - Industrialisation of the limestone quarry and landfill
 - Rewilding process in the Quarry
 - Talk about fragile ecosystems
 - End the hike with "hope for the future"
 - Will have the geopoints mapped out and volunteers will be present
 - Will be bringing first aid kits and an EpiPen
 - Might not be able to attend the conference/hikes if they get NSERC
 - Depends on whether they get the grant and the timing of their research project
 - Abby will be stepping in to help with the hikes

Miscellaneous Update with Alex

- Introduced Abby

- Has experience working with Ontario parks
- Can step in to do the hikes on Wylan's behalf
- Her sister is a falconer
 - The company her sister works for also has hawks and owls
 - Company works with the birds to circle mines and find seagulls to scare them away from the area
 - **Abby's idea:** sister could do a show or talk for OE3C
 - Alex suggested they could have a table for an exhibit instead (due to safety concerns)
- Volunteer call is out
 - **LOC members are advised the help send the link out**
 - **LOC can also sign up to be a session chair**
- Insurance form (student event risk management assessment) is in draft right now
 - Kiyoko and Lyly will review
 - **Need event monitors for the banquet (EMs cannot consume alcohol)**
 - Wylan will substitute for Lauren
- We need to get security for the event
- Judging site is in draft
 - Involves crowd judging
 - People will vote for the talks through this site
 - Each talk will have a code
 - Session chairs will also be judging
- Accommodations
 - From Kiyoko: Half of the hotel rooms have been released
 - Encourage people to sign up
- Thistle rooms
 - From Kiyoko: conference services changed the configuration of the rooms because there will be room for only 30 seats (the seats are different from the usual seats that are there)
 - We agree with booking the large plaza rooms as a backup option
 - Kiyoko will book the plaza rooms
- Program and schedule
 - Lyly has templates she can share
 - Everyone is responsible for writing their own part in the program
 - Workshops, outings, merch, etc.

Merch Update

- From Lauren: Lauren, Sarah, and Katherine met last week to talk about potential merch ideas and costs

- Notebooks with pen and RGB logo (made with recycled material)
 - Vista print: \$1240 for 200
- Stickers
- Tote bags
 - Vista: \$1300 for 150 canvas bags
 - Company that is making the t-shirts has a similar price
 - We agree with using a local business option for the tote bags
- Need to submit order 1.5 weeks into April (April 10-15th)
 - Shirts for sale at the conference?
 - Sarah suggested having a limited quantity of shirts for this
- Lanyards
 - Trying to contact campus stores

General Discussion and Adjournment

- Volunteers
 - Madelaine and Cassia have people that are interested in volunteering, but they are teenagers
 - Alex will look into whether this is an issue or not
 - Alex confirmed that 20 volunteers answered the call so far
 - Call went to upper year (Yr 3-4) undergrads first, then it will extend to con-eds, then 2nd-year students, then 1st-year students
 - Discount code will be sent to volunteers closer to the conference
- Name tags
 - Sarah and Lauren are willing to print them
 - Alex will try reaching out to Beattie's for help with printing
- **LOC members are advised to send Rasa any updates for the website**
- **LOC meetings will be held weekly from now on**

Meeting adjourned at 12:06 PM.